

Sarper Dündar

Technical Artist — Shaders, Tools & VFX

Bursa, Türkiye · sarperdundar@gmail.com · Open to relocation

Portfolio: sarper-dundar.github.io/portfolio

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical artist focused on Unity and the Universal Render Pipeline (URP) — procedural shaders, visual effects, and editor tooling for low-poly and stylized games. Publishes commercial assets on the Unity Asset Store under the Masingan studio name and works as lead 3D and technical artist on a co-op game in development for Steam. Came to game development after eleven years teaching and competing professionally in dance, moving into the field full-time in 2024. Writes hand-coded High-Level Shading Language (HLSL) and builds custom tools, with the goal of a technical artist role at a strategy game studio.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Engine & Rendering:** Unity 6, Universal Render Pipeline (URP), Shader Graph, High-Level Shading Language (HLSL), Compute Shaders, Visual Effects Graph (VFX Graph), Render Graph, custom Renderer Features, Unity Job System
- **Programming & Tooling:** C#, Python, Unity Editor scripting, custom editor tools, Git version control
- **Art & Content:** Blender, Substance Designer, Houdini, Adobe Creative Suite, Gaea, TextMeshPro (TMP)
- **Techniques:** procedural shader authoring, triplanar mapping, normal-map blending, depth-buffer effects, performance optimization, GPU instancing, tool and pipeline development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Masingan — Founder & Technical Artist

2024 – Present · Remote

- Founded a one-person studio publishing commercial Unity tools, shaders, and VFX assets for indie developers, focused on performance-first, low-poly-friendly solutions for URP.
- Own every stage of each product: technical design, HLSL and Shader Graph implementation, C# editor tooling, documentation, store presentation, pricing, and post-release support.
- Released the Searchlight System and submitted Surface Text Placer to the Unity Asset Store; currently developing the Low Poly Wet Surfaces shader package.

Area58 (The Surveyors Labs) — Lead 3D Artist & Technical Artist

2025 – Present · Remote

- Lead the 3D art team on a 1–6 player co-op horror game in development for Steam, directing two junior artists and setting performance-aware standards for modelling, texturing, and draw-call budgets.
- Rebuilt Synty's 3,000+ line, Amplify-generated ground shader from scratch in Shader Graph across eight render passes to gain full control, then extended it with custom wetness, dissolve, and overlay layers for Magio Pro compatibility.
- Diagnosed and fixed a GPU floating-point precision artifact in the triplanar blend — undocumented anywhere — by tracing the correction back to the original shader source.

Dansevi — Dance Instructor

2014 – May 2024 · Bursa, Türkiye

- Taught students from beginner to advanced level across a decade, translating complex technique into clear, individualized instruction — the foundation of the teaching and documentation skills now applied to technical art.
- Choreographed and directed performances, organized and coordinated events, held coordinator-level responsibilities at the schools, and judged at organized dance-sport competitions.

Matematik Röntgeni — Assistant Manager

Jan – Nov 2021 · Türkiye

- Designed and delivered weekly presentations for students and parents; supported the section head across media production, IT, and on-site event logistics.

Toxicity — UI Designer

Sep – Nov 2019 · Sofia, Bulgaria

- Designed UI mockups, wireframes, and production-ready assets for a shipped mobile game, coordinating with contractors to meet launch deadlines.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Searchlight System

Unity Asset Store · Released

- Volumetric searchlight for URP built on a procedural cone mesh that rebuilds each frame from Unity Job System parallel raycasts, with a hand-written unlit shader handling depth-buffer soft intersection, edge falloff, and animated noise.
- Resolved a mesh-clipping bug rooted in ring-vertex topology and a UV-seam normal artifact via co-located vertex averaging.

Low Poly Wet Surfaces

Unity Asset Store · In Development

- Reusable wetness subgraph — procedural puddles, rain ripples, and surface darkening — that drops into any URP shader through clean inputs and outputs.
- Wrote the procedural rain-ripple system as a custom HLSL function and built a four-face cylindrical triplanar with Reoriented Normal Mapping to eliminate seam artifacts.

Surface Text Placer

Unity Asset Store · Submitted

- Editor tool for placing TextMeshPro text on any surface with a single scene-view click: raycast placement, surface-normal orientation, live Inspector editing, full Undo support, and cross-session persistence.

Grand Strategy Map (collaborative)

Fantasy 4X · In Development

- Building the visual systems on top of a third-party map framework: custom shaders, fantasy effects, and atmospheric layers.
- Implemented EU4-style province-ID borders architected for a clean later upgrade to a Jump Flooding Algorithm (JFA) distance-field border system.

EDUCATION

AI & Technology Academy — Game Development Track

Dec 2024 – Aug 2025

- Admitted to the Game Development track of a selective, government-backed national program run under the Turkish Ministry of Industry and Technology in partnership with Google, the T3 Entrepreneurship Center, and the Entrepreneurship Foundation (one of roughly 500 scholars in the track).
- Eight-month, project-based program covering Unity, game design, UI/UX, AI-integrated gameplay, and game art, with technical workshops, hackathons, game jams, and a final graduation project.

Uludağ University — Graphic Design, Associate Degree

2016 – 2019 · Bursa, Türkiye

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Google Project Management Professional Certificate** — Coursera (2026). Six-course program (Foundations, Initiation, Planning, Execution, Agile, Capstone), completed on scholarship through the AI & Technology Academy.
- **Unity & Shader Development — Udemy**: Complete C# Unity Developer; Shader Development from Scratch (Cg); Unity Tech Art: Realistic Lighting; Complete Houdini FX Bootcamp; Substance Designer: Stylized Material Creation.

LANGUAGES

Turkish (Native) · English (Fluent) · German (Elementary) · French (Elementary)